



Gaming Laptops

Laptops are a difficult category for us, they seem so limiting when compared to the potential of a PC, especially when said PC can give you better performance for a third of the price of a normal gaming laptop. That said, we've been forced to accept that we live in a world where not everyone can be tied to a PC and there are many who'd love to take their gaming with them.

Keeping that in mind, we've always tested gaming laptops with that ideal in mind. We look for devices that are worthy of playing the games we want, at the resolutions and settings that we want. A laptop needs to be a complete package because what you get is what you'll have to live with till you get another laptop, so choose wisely.

Haswell is the biggest revolution in laptop tech. in a long time, but that's about it, which is a bit disappointing. Also disappointing is the fact that we haven't really received many laptops for testing, given that only a handful of new laptops have actually launched in India. We've seen a lot of new gimmicks, which includes backlit touchpads, RGB-backlit keyboards and even one particular laptop with a mechanical keyboard!

Another point in favour of laptop gamers is that in-game graphics seem to have plateaued at a point that's comfortable for laptop gamers, only losing out on extra graphical oomph that only the best of PCs



MSI GE60 2PE

Price: ₹1,12,000



MSI GS60 2PE

Price: ₹1,38,000



ASUS G551JK-DM053H

Price: ₹90,000

will be able to handle anyway. What's the configuration of an ideal gaming laptop today? A 4th generation i7 CPU, 8GB RAM and an Nvidia 850M series card of better. Such a system is perfect for running most games at medium-high settings, which should be enough for most of us.

Zero1 Winner

ASUS G551JK-DM053H

This is an interesting laptop for a number of reasons. First, its hardware is quite good as the device sports an Intel i7 4710 CPU, 8GB RAM and an Nvidia 850M GPU. What's interesting is that this laptop outperforms the likes of the MSI GE60 and GS60, both of which sport 860M GPUs. The laptop is also cheaper than the aforementioned competition and thus, it offers up a combination of price and performance that's hard to match.

The laptop does suffer in some departments, particularly screen quality, where we see too much backlight bleed and the keyboard and speakers aren't comparable to the competition. But then again, the touchpad is very nice and temperatures are kept in better check (which is probably the secret to its better performance).

Worthy Mentions

MSI GE60 2PE

If ever a laptop deserved to be ogled at, this has to be it. It's a very nice looking device with a stunning screen, we mean it, stunning. The quality of the display is so good that it puts many high-end desktop displays to shame as well.

Display aside, the hardware is good, our test model came with an i7 4710 CPU, 8GB RAM and an 860M GPU. Performance is excellent but for some inexplicable reason, it lags behind the Zero1 winner by a small amount in real-world gaming tests (by as much as 20% in Bioshock Infinite). Still, if you can get past that, this laptop offers you a more wholesome feature set, but at a price.

MSI GS60 2PE

The only thing that really separates the GS60 from the GE60 is that fact that the GS60 is sort of like an Ultrabook variant of the GE60. It's also slightly better equipped, sporting 16GB RAM, but it also compromises a bit on the keyboard and screen quality. Don't get us wrong, the keyboard and screen are quite excellent and better than that on most laptops, but they pale in comparison to their stellar counterparts on the GE60. This is an excellent choice if you want a light and portable gaming laptop. 